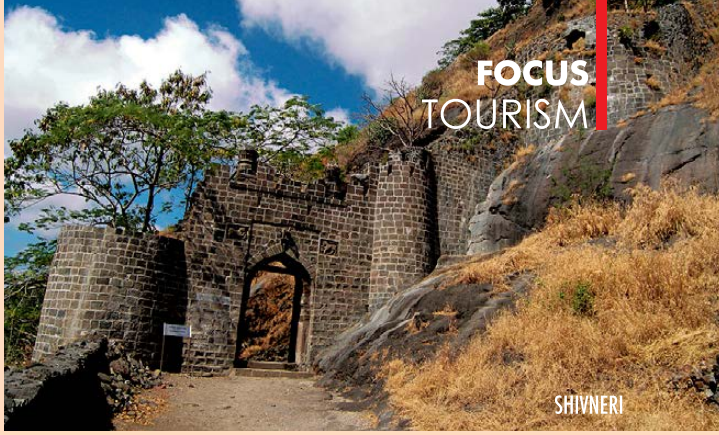

VIJAYDURG


SHIVNERI

Balaji Temple Balajipuram.

DAULATABAD FORT

Aurangabad

Also known as Devagiri, Daulatabad Fort was built in the 11th century by Yadava King Bhillama V. Serving various rulers, its unique rock-cut tunnel, moat, and numerous bastions showcase advanced military engineering. Highlights include the 210-foot Chand Minar and the Mendha canon.

How to go: Road: Mumbai – 312 km | Rail: Mangoan – 15 km

Nearby Sights: Ellora Caves, Grishneshwar Temple, Hiranya View Point, Chandminar View Point, Ajanta Caves, Bibi Ka Maqbara, Himayat Bagh, Bani Begam Bagh, Darwazas.

PANHALA FORT

Kolhapur

Panhala Fort, 20 km northwest of Kolhapur, is a historic hill fort perched 3,200 feet above sea level. Captured by Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj in 1673, it served as a key Maratha capital. Originally built in the 12th century by the Shilahara dynasty, it later fell under Yadava and Sultanate control before becoming a Maratha stronghold. Known for its stone walls and watchtowers, Panhala Fort remains a significant historical and tourist site.

How to go: Road: Mumbai – 375.9 km | Rail: Kolhapur – 30 km

Nearby Sights: Shri Mahalakshmi Temple, New Palace, Rankala Lake, Shree Jyotiba Temple, Kaneri Museum, Shri Binkhambi Ganesh Mandir, Shree Kopeshwar Mandir, Dajipur Wildlife Sanctuary, Rautwadi Waterfall, Radhanagari Wildlife Sanctuary & Dam.

KANDHAR FORT

Nanded

Built by Rashtrakuta king Krishna III in the 10th century, Kandhar Fort features a stepwell from the Yadava period and Persian inscriptions by Muhammad Bin Tughlaq. Legends connect it to the Mahabharata, and nearby archaeological relics enrich its historical narrative.

How to go: Road: Mumbai – 621.5 km | Rail: Nanded – 40 km

Nearby Sights: Manar Dam Warwant, Golegaon Fort, Shiradhon Fort, Limboti Dam Reservoir, Fort Nanded, Gurudwara Fountain, Mata Gujari ji Visava Garden, Shri Guru Gobind Singh Ji Museum, Kaleshwar Mandir Vishnupuri, Nadigram Fort, Asna River Dam.

SHIVNERI FORT

Pune

Shivneri Fort, the birthplace of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, is located in Junnar, 90 kilometers from Pune. This triangular hill fort features a 'chain entrance' and showcases architecture and water systems from the 1st century AD. It also houses the temple where Shivaji was named and the infamous Kadelot Point for criminal punishments.

How to go: Road: Mumbai – 202 km | Rail: Pune – 94 km

Nearby Sights: Lenyadri Caves, Shree Vighnahar Ganpati Temple, Vigneshwara Temple, Manikdoh Dam, Junnar Caves, Pimpalgaon Joga Dam, Girijatmaka Temple.

SINHAGAD FORT

Pune

Once known as Kondhana, Sinhagad Fort is renowned for its steep slopes and the 1670 Battle of Sinhagad led by Tanaji Malusare. The fort's relics, including monoliths of Tanaji and the Kaundinyeshwar Temple carvings, highlight its rich past.

How to go: Road: Mumbai – 180.2 km | Rail: Pune – 36.8 km

Nearby Sights: Dagdusheth Halwai Ganpati Temple, Pataleshvara Cave Temple, Shaniwar Wada, Empress Botanical Garden, Aga Khan Palace, Raja Dinkar Kelkar Museum.

TORNA FORT

Pune

Torna Fort, or Prachandagad, is located 65 km from Pune. Built in 1643 by Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, it played a key role in establishing Maratha sovereignty. Today, it is a popular trekking destination with scenic views, historic ruins, and opportunities for photography and bird watching. Visitors can explore the remains of old structures, walls, and temples reflecting its historical significance.

How to go: Road: Mumbai – 198.5 km | Rail: Pune – 54.6 km

Nearby Sights: Madhe Ghat Waterfall, Zunjar Machi, Kadve Khind, Shivsahyadri Hills, Nanemachi Waterfall, Rajgad Fort.

RAIGAD FORT

Raigad

Raigad Fort, 25 km from Mahad, was renovated by Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj and became the Maratha Empire's capital in 1674 AD. Perched 1,350 meters above sea level, it is renowned for its strategic importance and impressive architecture. The fort symbolizes Maratha resistance against Mughal rule and is a cultural heritage site with burial places for notable Maratha leaders. Today, Raigad Fort attracts tourists for its rich legacy and architectural marvels.

How to go: Road: Mumbai – 162 km | Rail: Mangoan – 27.7 km

Nearby Sights: Diveagar Beach, Jagadishwar Temple, Raj Bhavan, Madhe Ghat Waterfalls, Raigad Museum, Varadvinayak Temple, Ballaleshwar Temple.

PRATAPGAD FORT

Satara

Constructed in 1656 on Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj's orders, Pratapgad Fort was crucial during his conflict with the Adilshahi sultanate. The 1659 battle leading to Afzal Khan's death marked the Maratha Empire's rise. A 17-foot bronze statue of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, unveiled by Jawaharlal Nehru in 1957, stands here. The fort features temples and trekking routes, making it a historical and cultural treasure.

How to go: Road: Mumbai – 217.7 km | Rail: Pune – 142 km

Nearby Sights: Shivkalin Khedegaon, Krishnabai Temple, Elephant's Head Point, Mahabaleshwar Hill Station, Hunting Point, Mahabaleshwar Temple, Shri Panchganga Mandir, Lingmala Waterfalls.

SINDHUDURG FORT

Sindhudurg

Sindhudurg Fort, built on Khurte island by Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, began construction in 1664. This Maratha Navy headquarters features an irregular shape and deep indentations, reflecting Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj's tactical acumen. It provides insight into Maratha foresight and craftsmanship.

How to go: Road: Mumbai – 488.7 km | Rail: Kudal – 34 km

Nearby Sights: Malvan Marine Sanctuary, Jay Ganesh Mandir, Tarkarli Beach, Raghunath Market, Rock Garden, Tsunami Island Vengurla, Devbagh Beach.

VIJAYDURG FORT

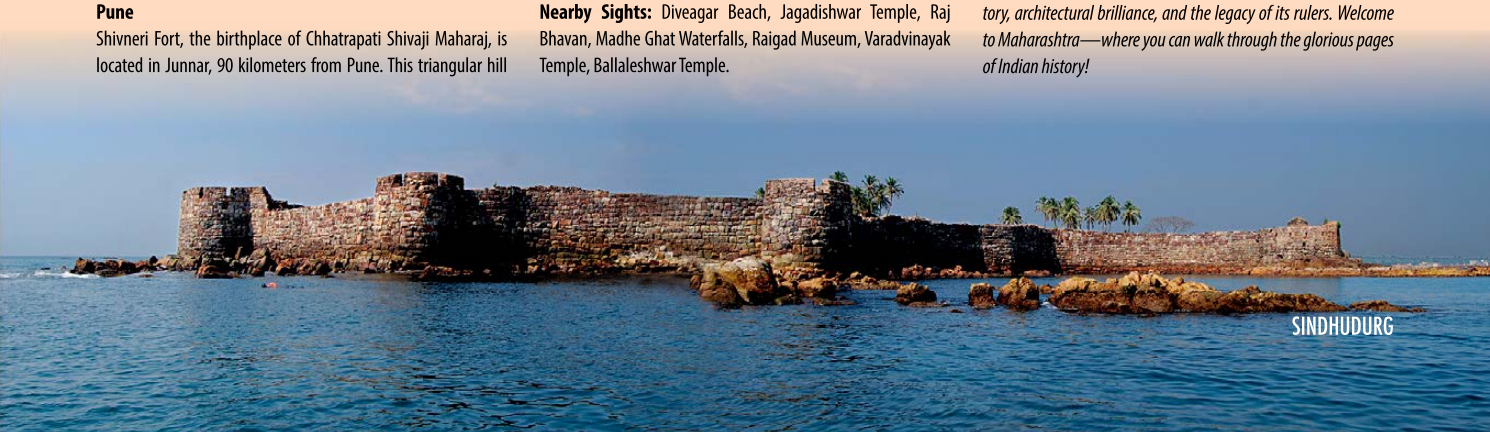
Sindhudurg

Vijaydurg, built between 1193 and 1205, was later captured by Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj in 1653. Known as the 'fort of victory,' it served as a strategic maritime fortress and is often called the 'Eastern Gibraltar' for its impregnable nature. Its construction with laterite stones and its coastal location make it a significant site for maritime history enthusiasts.

How to go: Road: Mumbai – 435.6 km | Rail: Rajapur Road – 63 km

Nearby Sights: Vijaydurg Beach, Kotharwadi Beach, Juve Bet, Kalambai Beach, Devgad Fort, Devgad Beach, Taramumbari Beach, Padavane Beach.

Maharashtra's forts are not just historical sites but cultural landmarks that host festivals and events, reflecting the region's rich history, architectural brilliance, and the legacy of its rulers. Welcome to Maharashtra—where you can walk through the glorious pages of Indian history!


SINDHUDURG